Emmanuel Mendieta

Technical Product Manager

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SUMMARY

I used to build first and ask later. Now I talk to customers, then build: three companies founded, a $250K pre-seed raised, and 7 engineers led at MARA. And I can build it myself.

SKILLS

Product: Customer discovery, PRDs, roadmapping, prioritization, pricing, go-to-market, usage analytics
Technical: TypeScript, Python, SQL, PostgreSQL, APIs, AI and LLM products, multi-agent systems
Tools: GitHub Projects, Stripe, Plaid, Salesforce API, Google Search Console, Vercel Analytics

EXPERIENCE

Queso Ventures — Founder

Jan 2026 – Present

- **Discovery:** earned SMB owners' trust by running their websites; they told me what SaaS to build next (missed-call text-back, SMS loyalty), and that became the roadmap.
- **Self-Serve:** owners launch tools themselves from their Queso portal, where most check in on their business.
- **Pricing:** raised new-client pricing 5x without losing a client, across dozens of paying clients.
- **Automation:** automated onboarding, billing, collections, reminders, and support so all of Queso runs itself.

Fordra — Co-Founder

May 2026 – Present

- **Growth:** first paying lenders came from my Lever network; now growing via industry leaders and outbound.
- **Product:** lead AI insurance verification that lenders run inside their own Salesforce, every day.

Lazo — Co-Founder & CTO

Sep 2025 – Jan 2026

- **Product:** shipped a WhatsApp AI tutor to 120 learners, owning the roadmap and the engineering.
- **Decisions:** cut 8 languages to 2 and set plan tiers from usage data; called the shutdown when retention fell.

Lever — Co-Founder & CTO

Apr 2025 – Sep 2025

- **Fundraising:** raised a $250K pre-seed round for a Bitcoin lending platform.
- **Pivot:** moved to logistics factoring on market feedback; cut verification from days to 1 business day.

MARA Digital Holdings — Lead Software Engineer

Feb 2024 – Apr 2025

- **Leadership:** led 7 engineers and shipped 6 cross-chain fintech apps for a public company.
- **Prioritization:** cut apps that ran long to keep the studio shipping toward its user-growth goal.
- **Revenue:** shipped Slipstream ($500K+ in its first 4–6 weeks) and led Avant ($2.2M+ in tokenized assets).

Freelance — Software Engineer

Aug 2019 – Jun 2023

- **Clients:** 30+ paying, from online universities to local SMBs and biomedical software; Queso's foundation.

EDUCATION

University of Houston | B.S. Computer Science, Minor in Mathematics — May 2023

Built by Queso Ventures
quesoventures.com/about